TryHackMe Writeup: Learning Cyber Security

Room: Web application security, network security, cybersecurity learning paths

Objective: Understand web application security, network security, and the recommended learning roadmap. The room's tasks include a web-security exercise and a question about the Target data breach.

Step 1 - Study web application security

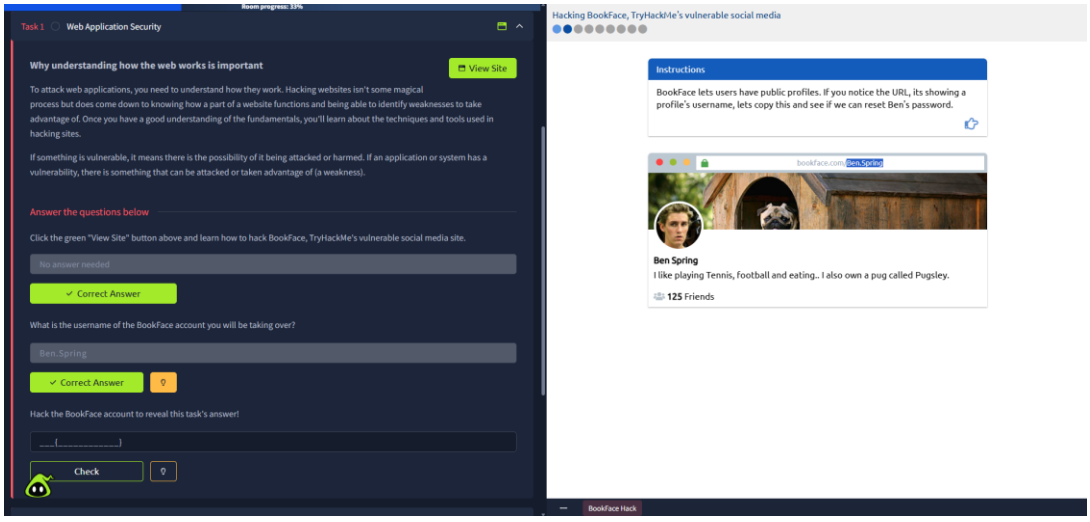
A web application runs through a browser or another client and communicates with a server. Common components include:

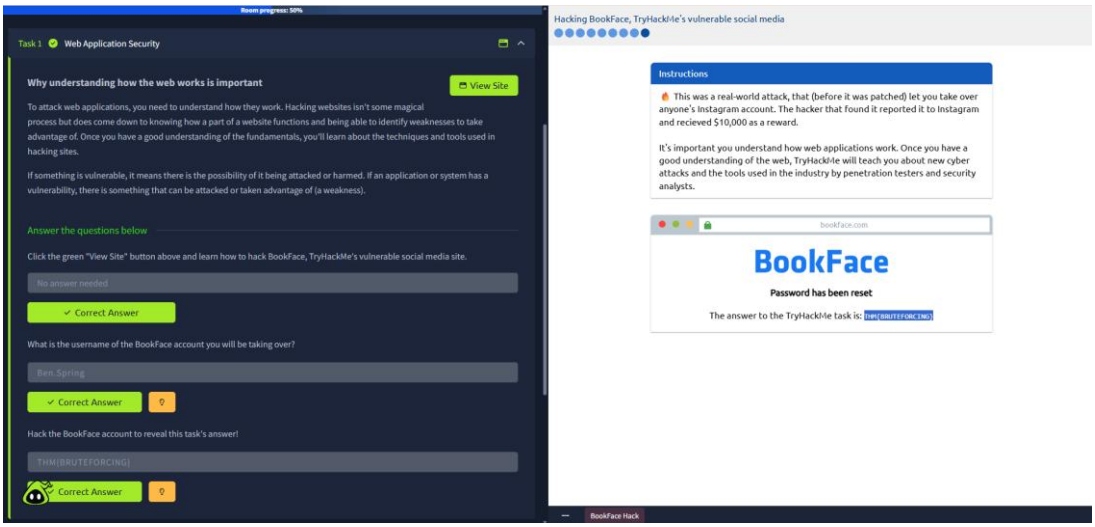
- Front end: the interface users interact with.
- Back end: application logic and processing.
- Database: stored application data.
- Authentication: verifying a user's identity.
- Authorization: deciding what that user may access.

A vulnerability is a weakness that could be exploited to affect the confidentiality, integrity, or availability of a system.

Step 2 - Complete the BookFace exercise

1. Open Task 1 in the TryHackMe room.
2. Select the provided View Site option.
3. Inspect the demonstration website and its instructions.
4. Identify the account specified by the task.
5. Follow the exercise's instructions to investigate the authentication weakness.
6. Submit the result returned by the lab.





The exercise demonstrates why weak authentication and passwords can put accounts at risk. Perform these activities only against the designated lab application.

Step 3 - Learn network security

Network security focuses on protecting systems and data as they communicate.

Study these concepts:

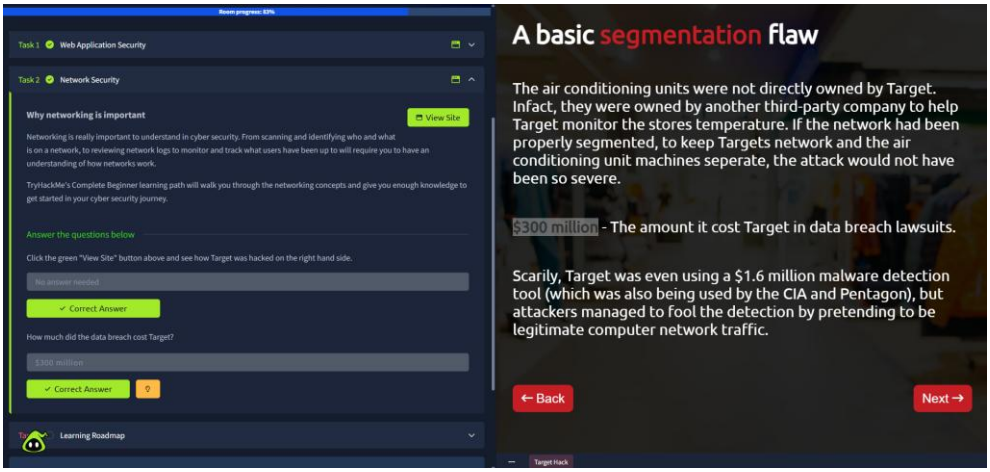
- IP addresses identify network interfaces.
- Ports identify services or communication endpoints.
- Firewalls control traffic according to rules.
- Network logs help analysts investigate activity.
- Network scanning can identify exposed services.

For example, a web server might accept HTTP or HTTPS connections while a firewall blocks unrelated inbound traffic.

Step 4 - Answer the Target breach question

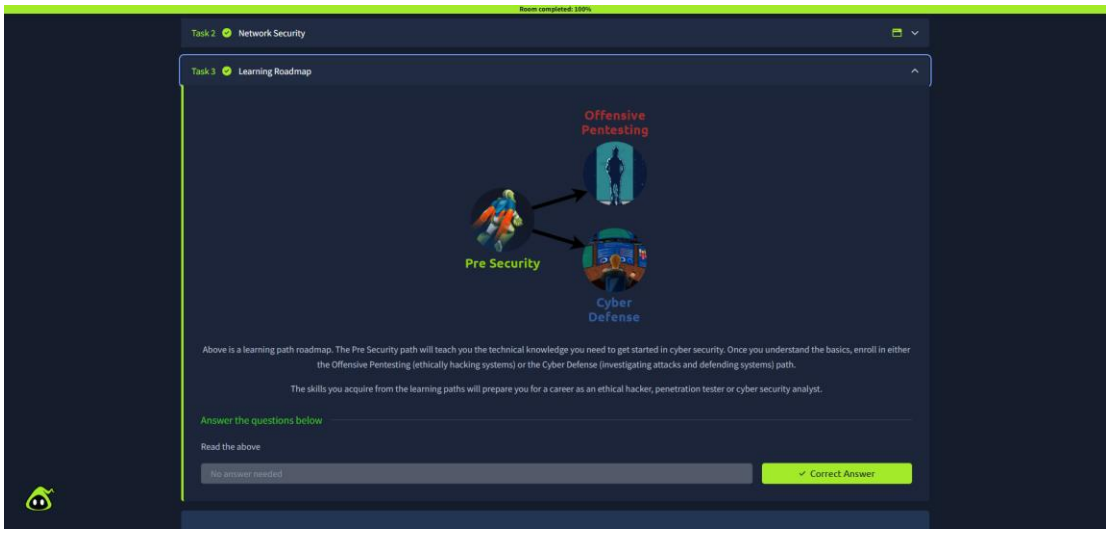
The room asks how much the Target data breach cost the company.

The commonly cited figure used by this room is $300 million.



Step 5 - Understand the learning roadmap

- The room recommends learning the technical foundations before choosing a specialization.
- Foundation - Linux, networking, operating systems, and the web.
- Offensive security - Ethical hacking, vulnerability assessment, and penetration testing.
- Defensive security - Security monitoring, threat intelligence, incident response, and digital forensics.



What you should learn: Cybersecurity is a broad field. Networking and operating-system knowledge provide the foundation for both offensive and defensive work.

